

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12386550
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 12, 2025
Inventor(s)	Sheng; Yue et al.

Memory device, memory system, and method for data calculation with the memory device

Abstract

A memory device, a memory system, and a method for data calculation with the memory device are provided. The memory device includes an array of memory cells and a peripheral circuit coupled to the memory cells is provided. The peripheral circuit includes page buffers configured to store first data transmitted from a data interface of the memory device and to sense second data from the array of memory cells. The peripheral circuit further includes at least one process unit coupled to the page buffers via a data-path bus of the peripheral circuit and configured to perform calculation based on the first data and the second data. The peripheral circuit further includes a control logic configured to program the second data into the array of memory cells.

Inventors: Sheng; Yue (Wuhan, CN), Xie; Shu (Wuhan, CN), Wan; Weijun (Wuhan, CN)

Applicant: YANGTZE MEMORY TECHNOLOGIES CO., LTD. (Wuhan, CN)

Family ID: 89983695

Assignee: YANGTZE MEMORY TECHNOLOGIES CO., LTD. (Wuhan, CN)

Appl. No.: 18/415273

Filed: January 17, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20250217072 A1	Jul. 03, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc WO PCT/CN2023/142313 20231227 PENDING child-doc US 18415273

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G06F3/06 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G06F3/0656 (20130101); G06F3/061 (20130101); G06F3/0679 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G06F (3/0656); G06F (3/061); G06F (3/0679)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
11836102	12/2022	Mathuriya	N/A	G06N 20/00
2018/0232273	12/2017	Plants	N/A	G06F 11/1068
2018/0240510	12/2017	Hush et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0042199	12/2018	Sumbul et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0317857	12/2018	Khan et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0243154	12/2019	Sity et al.	N/A	N/A
2023/0068645	12/2022	Fujiwara et al.	N/A	N/A
2023/0206967	12/2022	Park	N/A	N/A
2023/0317122	12/2022	Hung	365/189.05	G11C 16/26
2023/0343373	12/2022	Skadron	N/A	G11C 7/1039
2024/0143541	12/2023	Fouda	N/A	G06F 15/80
2024/0257842	12/2023	Tanaka	N/A	G11C 16/30

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
10-2005-0022855	12/2004	KR	N/A
10-2023-0014614	12/2022	KR	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

International Search Report issued in corresponding International Application No. PCT/CN2023/142313 mailed on Jun. 28, 2024, 3 pages. cited by applicant
International Search Report issued in corresponding International Application No. PCT/CN2023/142309, mailed on Jun. 28, 2024, 3 pages. cited by applicant
International Search Report issued in corresponding International Application No. PCT/CN2023/142312 mailed on Jun. 28, 2024, 3 pages. cited by applicant

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of International Application No. PCT/CN2023/142313, filed on Dec. 27, 2023, entitled “MEMORY DEVICE, MEMORY SYSTEM, AND METHOD FOR DATA CALCULATION WITH THE MEMORY DEVICE,” which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

- (1) The present disclosure relates to a memory device, a memory system, and a method for data calculation with the memory device.
- (2) Generative artificial intelligence (AI) reasoning involves AI computation. For example, transformer models usually use a tensor processing unit (TPU) and a memory for computation. Large transformer models require a large amount of data and computation, which requires high power consumption and sufficient memory. When an access speed of memory lags behind the computation speed of the processor, a memory bottleneck will prohibit high-performance processors playing effectively, and forms a great constraint to high-performance computing (HPC), this problem is called the memory wall. It is desired to break through the memory wall to further improve the performance of AI systems.

SUMMARY

- (3) In one aspect, a memory device including an array of memory cells and a peripheral circuit coupled to the memory cells is provided. The peripheral circuit includes page buffers configured to store first data transmitted from a data interface of the memory device and to sense second data from the array of memory cells. The peripheral circuit further includes at least one process unit coupled to the page buffers via a data-path bus of the peripheral circuit and configured to perform calculation based on the first data and the second data. The peripheral circuit further includes a control logic configured to program the second data into the array of memory cells.
- (4) In some implementations, the first data includes at least one row. The control logic is further configured to control the page buffers to receive each row of the first data based on a first data pattern.
- (5) In some implementations, the first data pattern includes N first data segments with equal data length, where N is a positive integer and $N \geq 2$, a sequence of the N first data segments of the first data pattern is the same as a sequence of the first data; and
- (6) every two adjacent first data segments of the first data pattern are separated by M first blank segments, where M is a positive integer and $M \geq 2$.
- (7) In some implementations, the data length of each first data segment is less than or equal to a bandwidth of the data-path bus.
- (8) In some implementations, the second data includes M columns. The control logic is further configured to program each column of the second data into the memory cells based on a second data pattern.
- (9) In some implementations, the control logic is further configured to program the second data into the memory cells in a single-level memory cell (SLC) mode.
- (10) In some implementations, the second data pattern includes N data groups each having M second data segments with equal data length from the M columns of the second data respectively. Every two adjacent data groups of the N data groups of the second data pattern are separated by one second blank segment, each second blank segment is corresponded to a first data segment respectively. The first data segment, the second data segment, the first blank segment, and the second blank segment are configured to have an equal data length.

- (11) In some implementations, each second data segment of the M second data segments of each data group of the N data groups is assigned with an error checking and correcting (ECC) code.
- (12) In some implementations, the data length of each second data segment is less than or equal to a bandwidth of the data-path bus.
- (13) In some implementations, the control logic is further configured to control the page buffers to sense the second data from the memory cells into the page buffers based on the second data pattern.
- (14) In some implementations, the control logic is further configured to control the page buffers to generate a third data having a third data pattern by performing an OR operation or an AND operation on the first data and the second data.
- (15) In some implementations, the third data pattern includes the N first data segments from the first data pattern and the N data groups each having M second data segments from the second data pattern. The M first blank segments between an ith first data segment and an (i+1)th first data segment of the N first data segments are replaced by the M second data segments of an ith data group of the N data groups, where i is a positive integer and $N \geq i \geq 1$.
- (16) In some implementations, each of the at least one process unit includes M process elements configured to perform convolution operations based on the ith first data segment of the N first data segments and the M second data segments of an ith data group of the N data groups.
- (17) In some implementations, the control logic is further configured to control the page buffers to send the ith first data segment and the M second data segments to the M process elements.
- (18) In some implementations, each of the at least one process unit includes a control element configured to assign the ith first data segment to each process element of the M process elements and assign the M second data segments to the M process elements one-by-one based on the sequence of the M second data segments.
- (19) In some implementations, the control logic is further configured to obtain a calculation result and output the calculation result to the data interface.
- (20) In some implementations, the array of memory cells is divided into more than one plane of memory cells, and a number of the at least one process unit is equal to a number of the planes of memory cells. Each process unit corresponds to a corresponding one of the plurality of planes of memory cells respectively.
- (21) In some implementations, the array of memory cells is divided into more than one plane of memory cells, and a number of the at least one process unit is less than a number of the planes of memory cells.
- (22) In some implementations, a number of the at least one process unit is half of the number of the planes of memory cells and each process unit corresponds to two corresponding planes of memory cells respectively.
- (23) In some implementations, a number of the at least one process unit is a quarter of the number of the planes of memory cells and each process unit corresponds to four corresponding planes of memory cells respectively.
- (24) In some implementations, a number of the at least one process unit is one and the one process unit corresponds to the plurality of planes of memory cells.
- (25) In some implementations, the memory device includes a NAND flash memory.
- (26) In another aspect, a method for data calculation with a memory device including an array of memory cells and a peripheral circuit coupled to the memory cells is provided. The method includes: obtaining, by page buffers of the peripheral circuit, first data from a data interface of the memory device; sensing, by the page buffers of the peripheral circuit, second data from the array of memory cells; and performing calculation, by at least one process unit of the peripheral circuit, based on the first and the second data.
- (27) In some implementations, the method further includes programming the second data into the array of memory cells.
- (28) In some implementations, the first data includes at least one row. Obtaining the first data from

a data interface of the memory device includes receiving each row of the first data based on a first data pattern.

(29) In some implementations, the first data pattern includes N first data segments with equal data length, where N is a positive integer and $N \geq 2$, a sequence of the N first data segments of the first data pattern is the same as a sequence of the first data, and every two adjacent first data segments of the first data pattern are separated by M first blank segments, where M is a positive integer and $M \geq 2$.

(30) In some implementations, the data length of each first data segment is less than or equal to a bandwidth of the data-path bus.

(31) In some implementations, the second data includes M columns. Programming the second data into the array of memory cells includes programming each column of the second data into the memory cells based on a second data pattern.

(32) In some implementations, the second data is programmed into the memory cells in a single-level memory cell (SLC) mode.

(33) In some implementations, the second data pattern includes N data groups each having M second data segments with equal data length from the M columns of the second data respectively, every two adjacent data groups of the N data groups of the second data pattern are separated by one second blank segment, each second blank segment is corresponded to a first data segment respectively; and the first data segment, the second data segment, the first blank segment, and the second blank segment are configured to have an equal data length.

(34) In some implementations, the data length of each second data segment is less than or equal to a bandwidth of the data-path bus.

(35) In some implementations, sensing the second data from the array of memory cells includes sensing, by the page buffers of the peripheral circuit, the second data from the memory cells based on the second data pattern.

(36) In some implementations, before performing calculation, further includes generating, by the page buffers, a third data having a third data pattern, by performing an OR operation on the first data and the second data.

(37) In some implementations, the third data pattern includes the N first data segments from the first data pattern and the N data groups each having M second data segments from the second data pattern. The M first blank segments between an i th first data segment and an $(i+1)$ th first data segment of the N first data segments are replaced by the M second data segments of an i th data group of the N data groups, where i is a positive integer and $N \geq i \geq 1$.

(38) In some implementations, performing calculation based on the first and the second data includes performing, by M process elements of each of the at least one process unit, convolution operations based on the i th first data segment of the N first data segments and the M second data segments of an i th data group of the N data groups.

(39) In some implementations, performing calculation based on the first and the second data includes sending the i th first data segment to each process element of the M process elements; and sending the M second data segments to the M process elements one-by-one.

(40) In some implementations, the method further includes obtaining a calculation result and outputting the calculation result to the data interface.

(41) In yet another aspect, a memory device including an array of memory cells and a peripheral circuit coupled to the memory cells is provided. The peripheral circuit includes page buffers configured to store first data transmitted from a data interface of the memory device and sense second data from the array of memory cells and at least one process unit coupled to the page buffers and configured to perform calculation based on the first data and the second data. The peripheral circuit further includes a control logic configured to control the page buffers to store a first piece of the first data and sense a first piece of the second data; store a second piece of the first data and sense a second piece of the second data consecutively; and store a third piece of the first

data and sense a third piece of the second data consecutively. The control logic is further configured to control the at least one process unit to perform a first calculation based on the first piece of the first data and the first piece of the second data during sensing the second piece of the second data; and perform a second calculation based on the second piece of the first data and the second piece of the second data during sensing the third piece of the second data consecutively.

(42) In some implementations, the control logic is further configured to output a first calculation result of the first piece of the first data and the first piece of the second data to the data interface during sensing the third piece of the second data.

(43) In some implementations, the control logic is further configured to program the second data into the array of memory cells.

(44) In some implementations, the first data includes at least one row. The control logic is further configured to control the page buffers to receive each row of the first data based on a first data pattern.

(45) In some implementations, the first data pattern includes N first data segments with equal data length; a sequence of the N first data segments of the first data pattern is the same as a sequence of the first data; and every two adjacent first data segments of the first data pattern are separated by M first blank segments, where M is a positive integer and $M \geq 2$.

(46) In some implementations, each piece of the first data includes one first data segment of the first data pattern.

(47) In some implementations, the data length of each first data segment is less than or equal to a bandwidth of the data-path bus.

(48) In some implementations, the second data includes M columns. The control logic is further configured to program each column of the second data into the memory cells based on a second data pattern.

(49) In some implementations, the control logic is further configured to program the second data into the memory cells in a single-level memory cell (SLC) mode.

(50) In some implementations, the second data pattern includes N data groups each having M second data segments with equal data length from the M columns of the second data respectively; every two adjacent data groups of the N data groups of the second data pattern are separated by one second blank segment, each second blank segment is corresponded to a first data segment respectively; and the first data segment, the second data segment, the first blank segment, and the second blank segment are configured to have an equal data length.

(51) In some implementations, each piece of the second data includes one data group of the N data groups of the second data pattern.

(52) In some implementations, each second data segment of the M second data segments of each data group of the N data groups is assigned with an error checking and correcting (ECC) code.

(53) In some implementations, the data length of each second data segment is less than or equal to a bandwidth of the data-path bus.

(54) In some implementations, the control logic is further configured to control the page buffers to sense the second data from the memory cells into the page buffers based on the second data pattern.

(55) In some implementations, the control logic is further configured to control the page buffers to generate a third data having a third data pattern by performing an OR operation or an AND operation on the first data and the second data.

(56) In some implementations, the third data pattern includes the N first data segments from the first data pattern and the N data groups each having M second data segments from the second data pattern. The M first blank segments between an i th first data segment and an $(i+1)$ th first data segment of the N first data segments are replaced by the M second data segments of an i th data group of the N data groups, where i is a positive integer and $N \geq i \geq 1$.

(57) In some implementations, each of the at least one process unit includes M process elements configured to perform convolution operations based on the i th first data segment of the N first data

segments and the M second data segments of an ith data group of the N data groups.

(58) In some implementations, each of the control logic is further configured to control the page buffers to send the ith first data segment and the M second data segments to the M process elements.

(59) In some implementations, each of the at least one process unit includes a control element configured to assign the ith first data segment to each process element of the M process elements and assign the M second data segments to the M process elements one-by-one based on the sequence of the M second data segments.

(60) In some implementations, the array of memory cells is divided into more than one plane of memory cells, a number of the at least one process unit is equal to a number of the planes of memory cells. Each process unit corresponds to a corresponding one of the plurality of planes of memory cells respectively.

(61) In some implementations, the array of memory cells is divided into more than one plane of memory cells, a number of the at least one process unit is less than a number of the planes of memory cell.

(62) In some implementations, a number of the at least one process unit is half of the number of the planes of memory cells. Each process unit corresponds to two corresponding planes of memory cells respectively.

(63) In some implementations, a number of the at least one process unit is a quarter of the number of the planes of memory cells. Each process unit corresponds to four corresponding planes of memory cells respectively.

(64) In some implementations, a number of the at least one process unit is one and the one process unit corresponds to the plurality of planes of memory cells.

(65) In some implementations, the memory device is a NAND flash memory.

(66) In still another aspect, a system including a memory device and a controller is provided. The memory device includes an array of memory cells and a peripheral circuit coupled to the memory cells. The peripheral circuit includes page buffers configured to store first data transmitted from a data interface of the memory device and to sense second data from the array of memory cells; and at least one process unit coupled to the page buffers via a data-path bus of the peripheral circuit and configured to perform calculation based on the first data and the second data. The controller is coupled with the memory device and configured to transmit the first data into the memory device and receive a result of the calculation from the memory device.

(67) In some implementations, the controller is further configured to transmit the second data into the memory device.

(68) In some implementations, the memory device is a NAND flash memory.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated herein and form a part of the specification, illustrate aspects of the present disclosure and, together with the description, further serve to explain the present disclosure and to enable a person skilled in the pertinent art to make and use the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 1A illustrates a block diagram of a system having a memory device, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 1B illustrates a diagram of a memory card having a memory device, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 1C illustrates a diagram of a solid-state drive (SSD) having a memory device, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.

- (5) FIG. 1D illustrates a schematic diagram of a memory device including peripheral circuits, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (6) FIG. 1E illustrates a block diagram of a memory device including a memory cell array and peripheral circuits, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (7) FIG. 1F illustrates a block diagram of a process unit, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (8) FIG. 2A illustrates first and second data processed by a memory device, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (9) FIG. 2B illustrates data shapes of the first and second data in FIG. 2A, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (10) FIG. 2C illustrates a first data pattern and a second data pattern used for processing the first data and the second data in FIG. 2A respectively, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (11) FIG. 2D illustrates a storage map of the second data in FIG. 2A based on the second data pattern in FIG. 2C, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (12) FIG. 2E illustrates a data flow in page buffers of the memory device, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (13) FIG. 2F illustrates a data flow within the memory cell array, the page buffer, and the process unit, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (14) FIG. 3A illustrates a data flow in a process unit of the memory device, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (15) FIG. 3B illustrates a data flow in a process unit of the memory device, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (16) FIG. 4 illustrates a process used for processing the first data and the second data in FIG. 2A based on the first data pattern and the second data pattern in FIG. 2C, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (17) FIG. 5 illustrates an operation pipeline of the memory device, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (18) FIG. 6 illustrates a flowchart of a method for data calculation with a memory device, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(19) In general, terminology may be understood at least in part from usage in context. For example, the term “one or more” as used herein, depending at least in part upon context, may be used to describe any feature, structure, or characteristic in a singular sense or may be used to describe combinations of features, structures or characteristics in a plural sense. Similarly, terms, such as “a,” “an,” or “the,” again, may be understood to convey a singular usage or to convey a plural usage, depending at least in part upon context. In addition, the term “based on” may be understood as not necessarily intended to convey an exclusive set of factors and may, instead, allow for existence of additional factors not necessarily expressly described, again, depending at least in part on context.

(20) Generative artificial intelligence (AI) reasoning involves AI computation. For example, transformer models, as a common model in AI systems, usually use a tensor processing unit (TPU) and a memory for computation. Large transformer models require a large amount of data and computation, which requires high power consumption and sufficient memory. When an access speed of memory lags behind the computation speed of the processor, a memory bottleneck will prohibit high-performance processors playing effectively, and forms a great constraint to high-performance computing (HPC), this problem is called the memory wall.

(21) To address one or more aforementioned issues and break the memory wall, the present disclosure introduces a solution in which a memory device and a method for calculation with the memory device is provided. A plurality of process units is provided in a peripheral circuit of the

memory device to perform calculations under the control of a control logic of the peripheral circuit. In this way, part of calculation tasks of the AI system can be distributed to the memory device of the AI system, especially tasks requiring large data-width. Without transferring the large data from the memory device to a processor of the AI system to perform calculations, the calculation tasks are completed within the memory device while the processor can process other calculations. Therefore, the calculation speed of the AI system is effectively improved by the introduction of the process units in the memory device.

(22) FIG. 1A illustrates a block diagram of a system **10** having a host **20** and a memory system **30**, according to some aspects of the present disclosure. System **10** can be a mobile phone, a desktop computer, a laptop computer, a tablet, a vehicle computer, a gaming console, a printer, a positioning device, a wearable electronic device, a smart sensor, a virtual reality (VR) device, an argument reality (AR) device, an artificial intelligence (AI) device, or any other suitable electronic devices having storage therein. As shown in FIG. 1, system **10** can include a host **20** and a memory system **30** having one or more memory devices **34** and a memory controller **32**. Host **20** can be a processor of an electronic device, such as a tensor processing unit (TPU), a central processing unit (CPU), or a system-on-chip (SoC), such as an application processor (AP). Host **20** can be configured to send or receive data to or from memory system **30**.

(23) Memory device **34** can be any memory device disclosed in the present disclosure, such as NAND Flash Memory, Vertical NAND flash memory, Dynamic Random Access Memory (DRAM), Ferroelectric Random Access Memory (FRAM), Magneto resistive Random Access Memory (MRAM), Phase Change Random Access Memory (PCRAM), Resistive Random Access Memory (RRAM), Nano Random Access Memory (NRAM), and so on.

(24) Memory controller **32** is coupled to memory device **34** and host **20** and is configured to control memory device **34**, according to some implementations. Memory controller **32** can manage the data stored in memory device **34** and communicate with host **20**. In some implementations, memory controller **32** is designed for operating in a low duty-cycle environment like secure digital (SD) cards, compact Flash (CF) cards, universal serial bus (USB) Flash drives, or other media for use in electronic devices, such as personal computers, digital cameras, mobile phones, etc. In some implementations, memory controller **32** is designed for operating in a high duty-cycle environment SSDs or embedded multi-media-cards (eMMCs) used as data storage for mobile devices, such as smartphones, tablets, laptop computers, etc., and enterprise storage arrays. Memory controller **32** can be configured to control operations of memory device **34**, such as read, erase, and program operations. Memory controller **32** can also be configured to manage various functions with respect to the data stored or to be stored in memory device **34** including, but not limited to bad-block management, garbage collection, logical-to-physical address conversion, wear leveling, etc. In some implementations, memory controller **32** is further configured to process error correction codes (ECCs) with respect to the data read from or written to memory device **34**. Any other suitable functions may be performed by memory controller **32** as well, for example, formatting memory device **34**. Memory controller **32** can communicate with an external device (e.g., host **20**) according to a particular communication protocol. For example, memory controller **32** may communicate with the external device through at least one of various interface protocols, such as a USB protocol, an MMC protocol, a peripheral component interconnection (PCI) protocol, a PCI-express (PCI-E) protocol, an advanced technology attachment (ATA) protocol, a serial-ATA protocol, a parallel-ATA protocol, a small computer small interface (SCSI) protocol, an enhanced small disk interface (ESDI) protocol, an integrated drive electronics (IDE) protocol, a Firewire protocol, etc.

(25) Memory controller **32** and one or more memory devices **34** can be integrated into various types of storage devices, for example, be included in the same package, such as a universal Flash storage (UFS) package or an eMMC package. That is, memory system **30** can be implemented and packaged into different types of end electronic products. In one example as shown in FIG. 1B,

memory controller **32** and a single memory device **34** may be integrated into a memory card **40**. Memory card **40** can include a PC card (PCMCIA, personal computer memory card international association), a CF card, a smart media (SM) card, a memory stick, a multimedia card (MMC, RS-MMC, MMCmicro), an SD card (SD, miniSD, microSD, SDHC), a UFS, etc. Memory card **40** can further include a memory card connector **42** coupling memory card **40** with a host (e.g., host **20** in FIG. **1**). In another example as shown in FIG. **1C**, memory controller **32** and multiple memory devices **34** may be integrated into an SSD **50**. SSD **50** can further include an SSD connector **52** coupling SSD **50** with a host (e.g., host **20** in FIG. **1A**). In some implementations, the storage capacity and/or the operation speed of SSD **50** is higher than those of memory card **40**.

(26) FIG. **1D** illustrates a schematic circuit diagram of a memory device **60** including peripheral circuits, according to some aspects of the present disclosure. Memory device **60** can be an example of memory device **34** in FIG. **1A**. Memory device **60** can include a memory cell array **62** and peripheral circuits **64** coupled to memory cell array **62**. Memory cell array **62** can be a NAND Flash memory cell array in which memory cells are provided in the form of an array of NAND memory strings **66** each extending vertically above a substrate (not shown). In some implementations, each NAND memory string **66** includes a plurality of memory cells coupled in series and stacked vertically. Each memory cell can hold a successive, analog value, such as an electrical voltage or charge, that depends on the number of electrons trapped within a region of the memory cell. Each memory cell can be either a floating gate type of memory cell including a floating-gate transistor or a charge trap type of memory cell including a charge-trap transistor.

(27) In some implementations, each memory cell is a single-level cell (SLC) that has two possible memory states and thus, can store one bit of data. For example, the first memory state “0” can correspond to a first range of voltages, and the second memory state “1” can correspond to a second range of voltages. In some implementations, each memory cell is a multi-level cell (MLC) that is capable of storing more than a single bit of data in more than four memory states. For example, the MLC can store two bits per cell, three bits per cell (also known as triple-level cell (TLC)), or four bits per cell (also known as a quad-level cell (QLC)). Each MLC can be programmed to assume a range of possible nominal storage values. In one example, if each MLC stores two bits of data, then the MLC can be programmed to assume one of three possible programming levels from an erased state by writing one of three possible nominal storage values to the cell. A fourth nominal storage value can be used for the erased state.

(28) As shown in FIG. **1Da** a schematic circuit diagram of an example memory device **60** including peripheral circuits, according to some aspects of the present disclosure. Memory device **60** can be an example of memory device **34** in FIG. **1A**. Memory device **60** can include a memory cell array **62** and peripheral circuits **64** coupled to memory cell array **62**. Memory cell array **62** can be a NAND Flash memory cell array in which memory cells **622** are provided in the form of an array of NAND memory strings **621** each extending vertically above a substrate (not shown). In some implementations, each NAND memory string **621** includes a plurality of memory cells **622** coupled in series and stacked vertically. Each memory cell **622** can hold a continuous, analog value, such as an electrical voltage or charge, that depends on the number of electrons trapped within a region of memory cell **622**.

(29) In some implementations, each memory cell **622** is a single-level cell (SLC) that has two possible memory states and thus, can store one bit of data. For example, the first memory state “0” can correspond to a first range of voltages, and the second memory state “1” can correspond to a second range of voltages. In some implementations, each memory cell **622** is a multi-level cell (MLC) that is capable of storing more than a single bit of data in more than four memory states. For example, the MLC can store two bits per cell, three bits per cell (also known as triple-level cell (TLC)), or four bits per cell (also known as a quad-level cell (QLC)). Each MLC can be programmed to assume a range of possible nominal storage values. In one example, if each MLC stores two bits of data, then the MLC can be programmed to assume one of three possible

programming levels from an erased state by writing one of three possible nominal storage values to the cell. A fourth nominal storage value can be used for the erased state.

(30) As shown in FIG. 1D, memory cells **622** of adjacent NAND memory strings **621** can be coupled through word lines **629** that select which row of memory cells **622** is affected by read and program operations. Each NAND memory string **621** can include a source select gate (SSG) **623** at its source end and a drain select gate (DSG) **624** at its drain end. SSG **623** and DSG **624** can be configured to activate selected NAND memory strings **621** (columns of the array) during sense, read, and program operations. In some implementations, the sources of NAND memory strings **621** are coupled through a same source line (SL) **625**, e.g., a common SL. In other words, all NAND memory strings **621** in the same block have an array common source (ACS), according to some implementations. DSG **624** of each NAND memory string **621** is coupled to a respective bit line **626** from which data can be read or written via an output bus (not shown), according to some implementations. In some implementations, each NAND memory string **621** is configured to be selected or deselected by applying a select voltage (e.g., above the threshold voltage of the transistor having DSG **624**) or a deselect voltage (e.g., 0 V) to respective DSG **624** through one or more DSG lines **627** and/or by applying a select voltage (e.g., above the threshold voltage of the transistor having SSG **623**) or a deselect voltage (e.g., 0 V) to respective SSG **623** through one or more SSG lines **628**.

(31) Referring to FIG. 1E, peripheral circuit **64** includes a Page Buffer (PB)/sense amplifier **71**, a column decoder/bit line driver **72**, a row decoder/word line driver **73**, a voltage generator **74**, a control logic **75**, an address register **76**, a data register **77**, a data interface **79**, a process unit **80**, and a data-path bus **81**. It should be understood that the above peripheral circuit **70** may be the same as the peripheral circuit **64** in FIG. 1D and in some other examples, peripheral circuit **70** may also include additional peripheral circuit not shown in FIG. 1E.

(32) Page buffer/sense amplifier **71** can be configured to sense, read and program (write) data from and to memory cell array **62** according to the control signals from control logic **75**. In one example, page buffer/sense amplifier **71** may store one page of program data (write data) to be programmed into one page of memory cell array **62**. In another example, page buffer/sense amplifier **71** may perform program verify operations to ensure that the data has been properly programmed into memory cells coupled to selected word lines. In still another example, page buffer/sense amplifier **71** may also sense the low power signals from bit line that represents a data bit stored in memory cell and amplify the small voltage swing to recognizable logic levels in a read operation. Column decoder/bit line driver **72** can be configured to be controlled by control logic **75** and select one or more NAND memory strings **66** by applying bit line voltages generated from voltage generator **74**.

(33) Row decoder/word line driver **73** can be configured to be controlled by control logic **75** and select/deselect blocks of memory cell array **62** and select/deselect word lines of block. Row decoder/word line driver **73** can be further configured to drive word lines using word line voltages generated from voltage generator **74**. In some implementations, row decoder/word line driver **73** can also select/deselect and drive SSG lines **628** and DSG lines **627** as well. As described below in detail, row decoder/word line driver **73** is configured to apply a read voltage to selected word line in a read operation on memory cell coupled to selected word line.

(34) Voltage generator **74** can be configured to be controlled by control logic **75** and generate the word line voltages (e.g., read voltage, program voltage, pass voltage, local voltage, verification voltage, etc.), bit line voltages, and source line voltages to be supplied to memory cell array **62**.

(35) Control logic **75** can be coupled to each peripheral circuit described above and configured to control operations of each peripheral circuit. Address register **76** and data register **77** can be coupled to control logic **75** and configured for storing status information, command operation codes (OP codes), and command addresses for controlling the operations of each peripheral circuit. Data interface **79** can be coupled to control logic **75** through a data-path bus **81** and act as a control buffer to buffer and relay control commands received from a host (not shown) to control logic **75**.

and status information received from control logic 75 to the host. Data interface 79 can also be coupled to column decoder/bit line driver 72 and act as a data input/output (I/O) interface and a data buffer to buffer and relay the data to and from memory cell array 62. Data interface 79 can also be coupled to data register 77 and process unit 80 to receive calculation results of process unit 80 and send the results to memory controller 32 or host 20.

(36) As shown in FIG. 1F, process unit 80 is illustrated. Process unit 80 includes a plurality of process elements 82, at least one first register 86, a plurality of second registers 88, and a control element coupled with the first and second registers 86 and 88. Process unit 80 can be coupled with page buffers 71 through a plurality of first registers 86 to receive first data from data latched of page buffers 71 and a plurality of second registers 88 to receive second data from memory cell array 62. The second data can be sensed by page buffers 71 from memory cell array 62. Process unit 80 further includes a plurality of process elements 82 coupled with the first registers 86 and second registers 88 and configured to perform convolution calculation based on the first data and the second data. Each process element 82 can include a result register configured to store a calculation result generated by the corresponding process element. A number of process element 82 equals a number of second registers 88 and a number of the columns of the second data. In the present implementation, each process unit includes six process elements and six second registers 88. Process unit 80 further includes a control element 84 configured to assign the first data and the second data to the plurality of process elements 82 according to preset data patterns. In some implementations, a number of the at least one first register 86 equals to a number of rows of the first data. For example, in the present implementation, each process unit 80 includes one first register 86. In some implementations, first registers 86 and the second registers 88 are first-in-first-out (FIFO) registers.

(37) AI systems are mainly used in two aspects: training and inference, and the present disclosure can be mainly used in AI inference, in which data is input into a trained AI module to be recognized and analyzed to obtain an expected result of the input data. In AI inference, calculations are performed based on the input data and data prestored in the AI system to confirm one or more nature of the input data. In AI inference, the input data may be a one-dimensional data and the reference data may be a two-dimensional data in many cases, as shown in FIG. 2A, in which the first data is a one-dimensional vector, and the second data is a two-dimensional matrix. In AI systems, three modules are provided to perform data calculations. The first module is computing near memory device, in which the calculations are performed outside the memory device. The second module is computing in memory cells, in which the calculations are performed by the memory cells of the memory device. The third module is processing in memory cells, in which the calculations are performed by additional process units of the memory device. The third module, i.e., processing in memory cells, is employed in the implementations of the present disclosure.

(38) FIG. 2B illustrates equivalence shapes of the first data and the second data in FIG. 2A. In some implementations, the one-dimensional first data can be equivalated as a row of data with a length of a , and the two-dimensional second data, i.e., the $a \times b$ matrix, can be equivalated as b columns, each column has a length of a . In some implementations, the first data can be a two-dimensional matrix including more than one row with an equal data length, and a dimensionality reduction can be performed on the more than one row of the first data to break the first data into a plurality of single row to apply the present disclosure.

(39) In some implementations, the first data and second data can be preprocessed before being processed to perform convolution in the memory device. In some implementations, the first data and second data can be preprocessed based on a first data pattern and a second data pattern as shown in FIG. 2C.

(40) In some implementations, the first data includes one row, and control logic 75 is configured to control page buffers 71 to obtain and send the row of the first data to the at least one process unit 80 based on a first data pattern as shown in FIG. 2C and FIG. 2D. The first data pattern includes N

first data segments with equal length, where N is a positive integer and $N \geq 2$. In some implementations, referring to FIG. 2D, every two adjacent first data segments of the first data pattern are separated by M first blank segments. For example, $N=4$ is taking as an example to illustrate the present disclosure, referring to FIG. 2D, the first data includes four first data segments based on the first data pattern, i.e., first data segment **S1-0**, first data segment **S1-1**, first data segment **S1-2**, and first data segment **S1-3**. Six first blank segments are arranged between first data segment **S1-0** and first data segment **S1-1**, six first blank segments are arranged between first data segment **S1-1** and first data segment **S1-2**, six first blank segments are arranged between first data segment **S1-2** and first data segment **S1-3**, six first blank segments are arranged between first data segment **S1-3** and consecutive first data segment. In some implementations, the first blank segments can be fulfilled with “1” instead of being blank. In some implementations, the first blank segments can be fulfilled with “0” instead of being blank.

(41) The sequence of the four first data segments of the first data pattern is the same as a sequence of the first data. In some implementations, the data length of each first data segment is less than or equal to the bandwidth of the data-path bus. The first data segments and the first blank segments are configured to have equal data length. In some implementations, an error checking and correcting (ECC) code is assigned to each first data segment to verify the first data segment. The ECC code can also be used as an identifier to recognize each first data segment of the first data pattern.

(42) In some implementations, the second data includes M columns, where M is a positive integer and $M \geq 2$. Control logic **75** is configured to program each column of the second data into the memory cells of memory cell array **62** based on a second data pattern as shown in FIG. 2C and FIG. 2E. The second data pattern includes N data groups each having M second data segments with equal data length from the M columns of the second data respectively, and the first data segment and the second data segment are configured to share an equal data length. Every two adjacent data groups of the N data groups of the second data pattern are separated by one second blank segment, and each second blank segment is corresponded to a first data segment respectively. For example, $N=4$ and $M=6$ are taking as examples to illustrate the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 2C, the second data includes six columns, i.e., Column 1, Column2, Column3, Column4, Column5, and Column6. Each column of the six columns includes four second data segments, i.e., second data segment **S2-0**, second data segment **S2-1**, second data segment **S2-2**, and second data segment **S2-3**. Referring to FIG. 2C, the six second data segments **S2-0** are regrouped as a first data group of the second data pattern, the six second data segments **S2-1** are regrouped as a second data group of the second data pattern, the six second data segments **S2-2** are regrouped as a third data group of the second data pattern, and the six second data segments **S2-3** are regrouped as a fourth data group of the second data pattern. Referring to FIG. 2E, the first data group of the second data is separated from a proceeding data group of the second data by second blank segment **S2-0**, the second data group of the second data is separated from the first data group of the second data by second blank segment **S2-1**, the third data group of the second data is separated from the second data group of the second data by second blank segment **S2-2**, and the fourth data group of the second data is separated from the third data group of the second data by second blank segment **S2-3**. In some implementations, the second blank segments can be fulfilled with “1” instead of being blank. In some implementations, the first blank segments can be fulfilled with “0” instead of being blank.

(43) In some implementations, referring to FIG. 2C and FIG. 2E, each data group of the four data groups of the second data pattern are programmed into the memory cell array **62** successively, i.e., logic addresses of the data of each data group are successive, so that the data of a same data group can be sensed into page buffers **71** at the same time. For example, in some implementations, six second data segments **S2-0** of the first data group and one second blank segment **S2-B** are successively programmed in block **0** of memory cell array **62**, six second data segments **S2-1** of the second data group and one second blank segment **S2-B** are successively programmed in block **1** of

memory cell array **62**, six second data segments **S2-2** of the third data group and one second blank segment **S2-B** are successively programmed in block **2** of memory cell array **62**, and six second data segments **S2-3** of the first data group and one second blank segment **S2-B** are successively programmed in block **3** of memory cell array **62**.

(44) In some implementations, a capacity of each block of memory cell array **62** is larger than at least twice of a data length of each data group, then two more data groups can be programmed within a same block of memory cell array **62** successively. In some implementations, the capacity of each block of memory cell array **62** is less than the data length of each data group, then each data group can be programmed in two successive blocks of memory cell array **62**. The sequence of the second data segments of the second data pattern is the same as a sequence of the second data. In some implementations, the data length of each second data segment is less than or equal to the bandwidth of the data-path bus. The first data segments, the first blank segments, the second data segments, and the second blank segments are configured to have equal data length. In some implementations, an error checking and correcting (ECC) code is assigned to each second data segment to verify the second data segment. The ECC code can also be used as an identifier to recognize each second data segment of the second data pattern.

(45) In some implementations, referring to FIG. 2F, control logic **75** is further configured to control page buffer **71** to obtain the first data and the second data and send them to the at least one process unit **80** based on the data sequence of the first data pattern and the second data pattern in FIG. 2C.

(46) In some implementations, the first data is sent into a second latch of page buffers **71** from data interface **79** based on the first data pattern, as shown in FIG. 2D and FIG. 2F, every two adjacent first data segments are separated by M first blank segments. The second data is sensed into a first latch of page buffers **71** from memory cell array **62** based on the second data pattern, as shown in FIG. 2E and FIG. 2F, every two adjacent data group of the second data are separated by one second blank segment.

(47) Control logic **75** is further configured to control the page buffers **71** to generate a third data having a third data pattern by performing an OR operation or an AND operation on the first data and the second data. The third data pattern includes the N first data segments from the first data pattern and the N data groups each having M second data segments from the second data pattern. The M first blank segments between an ith first data segment and an (i+1)th first data segment of the N first data segments are replaced by the M second data segments of an ith data group of the N data groups, where i is a positive integer and $N \geq i \geq 1$. In some implementations, the first blank segments and second blank segments are filled with “1” and will be replaced by the corresponding second data segments and first data segments after an AND operation. In some implementations, the first blank segments and second blank segments are filled with “0” and will be replaced by the corresponding second data segments and first data segments after an OR operation.

(48) Control logic **75** is configured to control the page buffers to send the ith first data segment and the M second data segments to the M process elements. Referring to FIG. 2F, at least one process unit **80** includes M process elements **82** configured to perform convolution operations based on the ith first data segment of the N first data segments and the M second data segments of an ith data group of the N data groups. Each of the at least one process unit **80** further includes a control element **84** configured to assign the ith first data segment to each process element of the M process elements and assign the M second data segments to the M process elements correspondingly based on the sequence of the M second data segments.

(49) For example, first data segment **S1-0** is sent into process unit **80** at first as shown in FIG. 3A, and first data segment **S1-1** is sent into process unit **80** after first data segment **S1-0** consecutively as shown in FIG. 3B. First data segment **S1-2** and first data segment **S1-3** are sent into process unit **80** consecutively after first data segment **S1-1** (not shown). Taking first data segment **S1-0** as an example, in some implementations, first data segment **S1-0** is sent to and buffered in the first register **86**. In some implementations, each process unit includes a control element configured to

assign the first data segment **S1-1** to each process element **82**, as shown in FIG. 3A.

(50) In some implementations, control logic **75** is further configured to control page buffers **71** to sense and send the data groups of the second data pattern to the at least one process unit **80** based on the data sequence of the second data pattern in FIG. 2C. For example, the six second data segments **S2-0** of the first data group are sent into process unit **80** at first as shown in FIG. 3A, and the six second data segments **S2-1** of the second data group are sent into process unit **80** after the first data group consecutively as shown in FIG. 3B. The six second data segments **S2-2** of the third data group of the second data are sent into process unit **80** consecutively after the second data group, and the six second data segments **S2-3** of the fourth data group of the second data are sent into process unit **80** consecutively after the third data group (not shown). Taking the six second data segments **S2-0** as an example, in some implementations, the six second data segments **S2-1** are sent to and buffered in the six second register **88**. In some implementations, each process unit includes a control element configured to assign the six second data segments **S2-1** to the six process elements correspondingly based on the sequence of the six second data segments **S2-1**, as shown in FIG. 3A.

(51) In some implementations, the M process elements **82** of each process unit **80** is configured to perform convolution operations based on an ith first data segment of the N first data segments and the M second data segments of an ith data group of the N data groups, where i is a positive integer and $N \geq i \geq 1$. Referring to FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B, in the present implementation, the first data segment **S1-0** is sent to each of the six process elements **82**, the six second data segments **S2-0** of the first data group of the second data are sent to the six process elements **82** one-by one, and convolution operations are performed by the six process elements **82** based on the first data segment **S1-0** and the six second data segments **S2-0** and obtain a first calculation result. In some implementations, the first calculation result is then sent to and saved in the corresponding result register of each process element **82** to perform further operations. In some implementations, the first calculation result can then be sent to and saved in data interface **79** under the control of control logic **75**. In some implementations, the first calculation result is then sent to and saved in memory cell array **62** under the control of control logic **75**. The first data segment **S1-1** and the six second data segments **S2-1** are then sent to the six process elements **82** to perform convolution operations and generate a second calculation result. The second calculation result is then sent to corresponding result register, data interface **79**, or memory cell array **62** by control logic **75** consecutively.

(52) A calculation principle of the at least one process unit is provided in FIG. 4, in which the ith first data segment is multiplied with the M second data segments of an ith data group of the N data groups to obtain an ith result. The N ith results are accumulated to obtain a convolution result. In some implementations, peripheral circuit **70** includes one process unit **80**, then the convolution operations between the calculations N first data segments and the N data groups of the second data are performed by the one process unit **80** consecutively. In some implementations, peripheral circuit **70** includes more than one process unit **80**, then the convolution operations between the calculations N first data segments and the N data groups of the second data are performed by different process unit **80** at the same time respectively.

(53) At least one process unit **80** is set within peripheral circuit **70** independently and is a separate module. With an increasement of a number of the at least one process unit **80** within peripheral circuit **70**, the calculation speed of peripheral circuit **70** improved while a larger area of peripheral circuit **70** is needed, there is a trade-off between the calculation speed and the area of peripheral circuit **70**. In some implementations, memory cell array **62** is divided into more than one plane of memory cells, each plane includes a plurality of memory cells. The number of the at least one process unit **80** is equal to a number of the planes of memory cells, which means that the at least one process unit **80** corresponds to the plurality of planes of memory cells one-by-one. For example, memory cell array **62** is divided into 128 planes of memory cells, and the number of at least one process unit **80** is also 128. In some implementations, the number of the at least one process unit **80** is less than a number of the planes of memory cells. For example, memory cell

array **62** is divided into 128 planes of memory cells, and the number of at least one process unit **80** may be 100, 64, 50, or other numbers less than 128. In some implementations, the number of at least one process unit **80** is half of the number of the planes of memory cells, and one process unit corresponds to two planes of memory cells respectively. For example, memory cell array **62** is divided into 128 planes of memory cells, and the number of at least one process unit **80** is 64. In some implementations, the number of at least one process unit **80** is a quarter of the number of the planes of memory cells, and one process unit corresponds to four planes of memory cells respectively. For example, memory cell array **62** is divided into 128 planes of memory cells, and the number of at least one process unit **80** is 32. The number of at least one process unit **80** can be set and adjusted based on the need of the AI system, the implementations of the present disclosure aim to illustrate the present disclosure and should not be explained as limitations.

(54) In another aspect of the present disclosure, control logic **75** of peripheral circuit **70** is configured to control page buffers **71** to obtain a first piece of the first data, a second piece of the first data, and a third piece of the first data consecutively. Control logic **75** of peripheral circuit **70** is further configured to control page buffers **71** to sense a first piece of the second data, a second piece of the second data, and a third piece of the second data consecutively. Control logic **75** of peripheral circuit **70** is further configured to perform a first calculation based on the first piece of the first data and the first piece of the second data during sensing the second piece of the second data and perform a second calculation based on the second piece of the first data and the second piece of the second data during sensing the third piece of the second data consecutively. Control logic **75** of peripheral circuit **70** is further configured to output a first calculation result of the first piece of the first data and the first piece of the second data to the data interface during sensing the third piece of the second data.

(55) In some implementations, referring to FIG. 5, and operation pipeline of one process unit **80** is illustrated. As described above, the first data includes at least one row, and control logic **75** is configured to control page buffers **71** to receive each row of the first data based on a first data pattern.

(56) The first data pattern includes N first data segments with equal data length, where N is a positive integer and $N \geq 2$, and a sequence of the N first data segments of the first data pattern is the same as a sequence of the first data. The data length of each first data segment is less than or equal to the bandwidth of data-path bus **81**. In the present implementation, as shown FIG. 2C, each piece of the first data includes a first data segment, for example, the first piece of first data can be first data segment **S1-0**, the second piece of first data can be first data segment **S1-1**, the third piece of first data can be first data segment **S1-2**, and the fourth piece of first data can be first data segment **S1-3**. In some implementation, the Nth piece of first data can be first data segment **S1-(N-1)**. In some implementations, each piece of the first data can includes a data segment longer or shorter than the first data segment based on a bandwidth of the data-path bus **81** and other data width of peripheral circuit **70**.

(57) The second data includes M columns, where M is a positive integer and $M \geq 2$. Control logic **75** is configured to program each column of the second data into the memory cells based on a second data pattern. In some implementations, control logic **75** is configured to program the second data into the memory cells as single-level memory cells (SLC). The second data pattern includes N data groups each having M second data segments with equal data length from the M columns of the second data respectively, and the first data segment and the second data segment are configured to share an equal data length. In some implementations, each piece of the second data corresponds with the piece of first data to be multiplied with, for example, the first piece of the second data can be the six second data segments **S2-0** of the first data group of the second data that will be multiplied with the first data segment **S1-0**, the second piece of the second data can be the six second data segments **S2-1** of the second data group of the second data that will be multiplied with the first data segment **S1-1**, the third piece of the second data can be the six second data segments

S2-2 of the third data group of the second data that will be multiplied with the first data segment S1-2, and the fourth piece of the second data can be the six second data segments S2-0 of the fourth data group of the second data that will be multiplied with the first data segment S1-3. In some implementations, the Nth piece of the second data can be the six second data segments S2-(N-1) of the Nth data group of the second data that will be multiplied with the first data segment S1-(N-1).

(58) In some implementations, the operation pipeline shown in FIG. 5 is performed by at least one process element 82 of each process unit 80. Control logic 75 is configured to control page buffers 71 to send the ith first data segment to each process element 82 and control page buffers 71 to send the M second data segments to the M process elements 82. Each of the at least one process unit 80 includes a control element 84 configured to assign the M second data segments to the M process elements one-by-one based on the sequence of the M second data segments.

(59) Referring to FIG. 5, an initial cycle C0 is configured for preparation of process unit 80. The operation pipeline starts from a first cycle C1, in which a first piece of first data is obtained by page buffers 71 and send to process elements 82 of process unit 80, while a first piece of second data is sensed by page buffers 71 and send to process elements 82 of process unit 80.

(60) In a second cycle C2 consecutive of the first cycle C1, a first calculation is performed by process elements 82 and a first result is generated based on the first piece of first data and the first piece of second data. The first result is copied by control logic 75 at the end of the second cycle C2. At the same time, a second piece of first data is sensed by page buffers 71 and sent to process elements 82, while a second piece of second data is sensed by page buffers 71 and send to process elements 82.

(61) Consecutively, in a third cycle C3, the first result is sent to data interface 79, which costs much less time than sensing data or performing calculations, thus the outputting of the first result can be performed any time during the third cycle C3. During the third cycle C3, a second calculation is performed by process elements 82 and a second result is generated based on the second piece of first data and the second piece of second data. The second result is copied by control logic 75 at the end of the second cycle C2. At the same time, a third piece of first data is sensed by page buffers 71 and sent to process elements 82, while a third piece of second data is sensed by page buffers 71 and sent to process elements 82.

(62) Consecutively, in a fourth cycle C4, the second result is sent to data interface 79, while a third calculation is performed by process elements 82 and a third result is generated based on the third piece of first data and the third piece of second data. At the same time, a fourth piece of first data is obtained by page buffers 71 and sent to process elements 82, while a fourth piece of second data is sensed by page buffers 71 and sent to process elements 82. Similarly, in a ith cycle Ci, the (i-2)th result is sent to data interface 79, while an (i-1)th calculation is performed by process elements 82 and a (i-1)th result is generated based on the (i-1)th piece of first data and the (i-1)th piece of second data. At the same time, an ith piece of first data is obtained by page buffers 71 and sent to process elements 82, while an ith piece of second data is sensed by page buffers 71 and send to process elements 82. With the application of the operation pipeline in FIG. 5, the sensing of the first and second data, the performing of the convolution calculation, and the outputting of the calculation result can be completed within a single cycle to improve the calculation effective. In some implementations, only the sensing of the first and second data and the performing of the convolution calculation.

(63) A system including a memory device and a memory controller is provided according to an aspect of the present disclosure. The memory device includes an array of memory cells and a peripheral circuit coupled to the memory cells. The peripheral circuit includes page buffers configured to obtain first data from the data interface and sense second data from the array of memory cells, and at least one process unit coupled to the page buffers via a data-path bus of the peripheral circuit and configured to perform calculation based on the first data and the second data. The controller is coupled with the memory device and configured to transmit the first data into the

memory device and receive a result of the calculation from the memory device.

(64) In some implementations, the system can be any electrical system applied with an AI system, such as computers, digital cameras, mobile phones, smart electrical appliances, Internet of Things (IoT), servers, base stations, and the like. In the present disclosure, data processing and computing of the AI system can be performed by process units **80** of peripheral circuit of a memory device. In some implementations, computing tasks consuming a large number of resources can be distributed to memory device rather than the TPU or a graphic processing unit (GPU) by adding at least one process unit into the memory device to improve the performance of the AI system. The number of process units can be designed based on the needs of the AI system. The more process units are integrated into the memory device, the higher effective the AI system will be.

(65) Referring to FIG. 6, FIG. 6 illustrates a flowchart of a method **600** for data calculation with a memory device including array of memory cell array **62** and peripheral circuit **70** coupled to the memory cell array **62**, the memory device can be the same as described above and will not be repeated herein. It is understood that the operations shown in method **600** are not exhaustive and that other operations can be performed as well before, after, or between any of the illustrated operations. Further, some of the operations may be performed simultaneously, or in a different order than shown in FIG. 6.

(66) As shown in FIG. 6, method **600** can start at operation **602**, in which first data is obtained from a data interface of the memory device by page buffers of the peripheral circuit. Method **600** can start at operation **604**, in which second data is sensed from the array of memory cells by the page buffers. It should be noted that there is no limitation on the performance of operation **602** and operation **604**. Operation **602** can be performed before, after, or simultaneous with operation **604**. In some implementations, to improve the computing effectiveness of the memory device, operation **602** and operation **604** can be performed during a same time period. The sequence of operations **602** and **604** should not limit the scope of the present disclosure.

(67) In some implementations, the first data may be a one-dimensional data and the second data may be a two-dimensional data in many cases, as shown in FIG. 2A, in which the first data is a one-dimensional vector, and the second data is a two-dimensional matrix. In some implementations, the one-dimensional first data can be equivalated as a row of data with a length of a , and the two-dimensional second data, i.e., the $a \times b$ matrix, can be equivalated as b columns, each column has a length of a . In some implementations, the first data can be a two-dimensional matrix including more than one row with an equal data length, and a dimensionality reduction can be performed on the more than one row of the first data to break the first data into a plurality of single row to apply the present disclosure.

(68) In some implementations, the first data and second data can be preprocessed before operation **602** and **604**. In some implementations, the first data and second data can be preprocessed based on a first data pattern and a second data pattern as shown in FIG. 2C.

(69) In some implementations, the first data includes one row. The first data is obtained by page buffers **71** from data interface **79** and is sent to the at least one process unit **80** based on a first data pattern as shown in FIG. 2C and FIG. 2D. The first data pattern includes N first data segments with equal length, where N is a positive integer and $N \geq 2$. In some implementations, referring to FIG. 2D, every two adjacent first data segments of the first data pattern are separated by M first blank segments. For example, $N=4$ is taking as an example to illustrate the present disclosure, referring to FIG. 2D, the first data includes four first data segments based on the first data pattern, i.e., first data segment **S1-0**, first data segment **S1-1**, first data segment **S1-2**, and first data segment **S1-3**. Six first blank segments are arranged between first data **S1-0** and first data segment **S1-1**, six first blank segments are arranged between first data segment **S1-1** and first data segment **S1-2**, six first blank segments are arranged between first data segment **S1-2** and first data segment **S1-3**, six first blank segments are arranged between first data segment **S1-3** and consecutive first data segment.

(70) The sequence of the four first data segments of the first data pattern is the same as a sequence

of the first data. In some implementations, the data length of each first data segment is less than or equal to the bandwidth of the data-path bus. The first data segments and the first blank segments are configured to have equal data length. In some implementations, an error checking and correcting (ECC) code is assigned to each first data segment to verify the first data segment. The ECC code can also be used as an identifier to recognize each first data segment of the first data pattern.

(71) In some implementations, the second data includes M columns, where M is a positive integer and $M \geq 2$. The second data is programmed into the memory cells of memory cell array **62** based on a second data pattern as shown in FIG. 2C and FIG. 2E. The second data pattern includes N data groups each having M second data segments with equal data length from the M columns of the second data respectively, and the first data segment and the second data segment are configured to share an equal data length. Every two adjacent data groups of the N data groups of the second data pattern are separated by one second blank segment, and each second blank segment is corresponded to a first data segment respectively. For example, $N=4$ and $M=6$ are taking as examples to illustrate the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 2C, the second data includes six columns, i.e., Column 1, Column2, Column3, Column4, Column5, and Column6. Each column of the six columns includes four second data segments, i.e., second data segment S2-0, second data segment S2-1, second data segment S2-2, and second data segment S2-3. Referring to FIG. 2C, the six second data segments S2-0 are regrouped as a first data group of the second data pattern, the six second data segments S2-1 are regrouped as a second data group of the second data pattern, the six second data segments S2-2 are regrouped as a third data group of the second data pattern, and the six second data segments S2-3 are regrouped as a fourth data group of the second data pattern. Referring to FIG. 2E, the first data group of the second data is separated from a proceeding data group of the second data by second blank segment S2-0, the second data group of the second data is separated from the first data group of the second data by second blank segment S2-1, the third data group of the second data is separated from the second data group of the second data by second blank segment S2-2, and the fourth data group of the second data is separated from the third data group of the second data by second blank segment S2-3.

(72) In some implementations, referring to FIG. 2C and FIG. 2E, each data group of the four data groups of the second data pattern are programmed into the memory cell array **62** successively, i.e., logic addresses of the data of each data group are successive, so that the data of a same data group can be sensed into page buffers **71** at the same time. For example, in some implementations, six second data segments S2-0 of the first data group and one second blank segment S2-B are successively programmed in block **0** of memory cell array **62**, six second data segments S2-1 of the second data group and one second blank segment S2-B are successively programmed in block **1** of memory cell array **62**, six second data segments S2-2 of the third data group and one second blank segment S2-B are successively programmed in block **2** of memory cell array **62**, and six second data segments S2-3 of the first data group and one second blank segment S2-B are successively programmed in block **3** of memory cell array **62**.

(73) In some implementations, a capacity of each block of memory cell array **62** is larger than at least twice of a data length of each data group, then two more data groups can be programmed within a same block of memory cell array **62** successively. In some implementations, the capacity of each block of memory cell array **62** is less than the data length of each data group, then each data group can be programmed in two successive blocks of memory cell array **62**. The sequence of the second data segments of the second data pattern is the same as a sequence of the second data. In some implementations, the data length of each second data segment is less than or equal to the bandwidth of the data-path bus. The first data segments, the first blank segments, the second data segments, and the second blank segments are configured to have equal data length. In some implementations, an error checking and correcting (ECC) code is assigned to each second data segment to verify the second data segment. The ECC code can also be used as an identifier to

recognize each second data segment of the second data pattern.

(74) In some implementations, referring to FIG. 2F, the first data and the second data are sent to the at least one process unit **80** based on the data sequence of the first data pattern and the second data pattern in FIG. 2C.

(75) In some implementations, the first data is obtained into a second latch of page buffers **71** from data interface **79** based on the first data pattern, as shown in FIG. 2D and FIG. 2F, every two adjacent first data segments are separated by M first blank segments. The second data is sensed into a first latch of page buffers **71** from memory cell array **62** based on the second data pattern, as shown in FIG. 2E and FIG. 2F, every two adjacent data group of the second data are separated by one second blank segment.

(76) In some implementations, third data having a third data pattern by performing an OR operation on the first data and the second data, which means that the first blank segments and second blank segments are replaced by the corresponding second data segments and first data segments after the OR operation or the AND operation. The third data can be saved into a third data latch of page buffer **71** or can be saved back into the first or the second data latch. The third data pattern includes the N first data segments from the first data pattern and the N data groups each having M second data segments from the second data pattern. The M first blank segments between an ith first data segment and an (i+1)th first data segment of the N first data segments are replaced by the M second data segments of an ith data group of the N data groups, where i is a positive integer and $N \geq i \geq 1$.

(77) As shown in FIG. 6, method **600** can start at operation **606**, in which calculation is performed by at least one process unit of the peripheral circuit based on the first and the second data.

(78) In some implementations, operation **606** includes performing convolution operations by the M process elements **82** of each process unit **80** based on an ith first data segment of the N first data segments and the M second data segments of an ith data group of the N data groups, where i is a positive integer and $N \geq i \geq 1$. Referring to FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B, in the present implementation, the first data segment **S1-0** is sent to each of the six process elements **82**, the six second data segments **S2-0** of the first data group of the second data are sent to the six process elements **82** one-by-one, and convolution operations are performed by the six process elements **82** based on the first data segment **S1-0** and the six second data segments **S2-0** and obtain a first calculation result. The first calculation result is then sent to data interface **79** by control logic **75**. The first data segment **S1-1** and the six second data segments **S2-1** are then sent to the six process elements **82** to perform convolution operations and generate a second calculation result. The second calculation result is then sent to data interface **79** by control logic **75** consecutively.

(79) A calculation principle of the at least one process unit is provided in FIG. 4, in which the ith first data segment is multiplied with the M second data segments of an ith data group of the N data groups to obtain an ith result. The N ith results are accumulated to obtain a convolution result. In some implementations, peripheral circuit **70** includes one process unit **80**, then the convolution operations between the calculations N first data segments and the N data groups of the second data are performed by the one process unit **80** consecutively. In some implementations, peripheral circuit **70** includes more than one process unit **80**, then the convolution operations between the calculations N first data segments and the N data groups of the second data are performed by different process unit **80** at the same time respectively.

(80) The foregoing description of the specific implementations can be readily modified and/or adapted for various applications. Therefore, such adaptations and modifications are intended to be within the meaning and range of equivalents of the disclosed implementations, based on the teaching and guidance presented herein.

(81) The breadth and scope of the present disclosure should not be limited by any of the above-described implementations but should be defined only in accordance with the following claims and their equivalents.

(82) Although specific configurations and arrangements are discussed, it should be understood that

this is done for illustrative purposes only. As such, other configurations and arrangements can be used without departing from the scope of the present disclosure. Also, the subject matter as described in the present disclosure can also be used in a variety of other applications. Functional and structural features as described in the present disclosures can be combined, adjusted, modified, and rearranged with one another and in ways that are consistent with the scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A memory device comprising: an array of memory cells; and a peripheral circuit coupled to the array of memory cells and comprising: page buffers configured to store first data comprising at least one row transmitted from a data interface of the memory device and to sense second data comprising at least two columns from the array of memory cells; at least one process unit coupled to the page buffers via a data-path bus of the peripheral circuit, and configured to perform calculation based on the first data and the second data; and a control logic configured to: control the page buffers to receive each row of the first data based on a first data pattern comprising at least two first data segments with equal data length, wherein two adjacent first data segments of the first data pattern are separated by at least two first blank segments; and program the at least two columns of the second data into the array of memory cells based on a second data pattern comprising at least two data groups corresponding to the at least two first data segments of the first data pattern respectively.
2. The memory device of claim 1, wherein the first data pattern comprises N first data segments with equal data length, where N is a positive integer and $N \geq 2$; an order of the N first data segments of the first data pattern matches a sequence of the N first data segments originally arranged in the first data; and every two adjacent first data segments of the first data pattern are separated by M first blank segments, where M is a positive integer and $M \geq 2$.
3. The memory device of claim 2, wherein the second data comprises M columns; and the control logic is further configured to program each column of the second data into the memory cells based on a second data pattern.
4. The memory device of claim 3, wherein the control logic is further configured to program the second data into the memory cells in a single-level memory cell (SLC) mode.
5. The memory device of claim 3, wherein the second data pattern comprises N data groups each having M second data segments with equal data length from the M columns of the second data respectively; every two adjacent data groups of the N data groups of the second data pattern are separated by one second blank segment, each second blank segment is corresponded to a first data segment respectively; and the first data segment, the second data segment, the first blank segment, and the second blank segment are configured to have an equal data length.
6. The memory device of claim 5, wherein each second data segment of the M second data segments of each data group of the N data groups is assigned with an error checking and correcting (ECC) code.
7. The memory device of claim 5, wherein the control logic is further configured to control the page buffers to sense the second data from the memory cells into the page buffers based on the second data pattern.
8. The memory device of claim 5, wherein the control logic is further configured to control the page buffers to generate a third data having a third data pattern by performing an OR operation or an AND operation on the first data and the second data.
9. The memory device of claim 8, the third data pattern comprising: the N first data segments from the first data pattern; and the N data groups each having M second data segments from the second data pattern, wherein the M first blank segments between an i th first data segment and an $(i+1)$ th first data segment of the N first data segments are replaced by the M second data segments of an i th

data group of the N data groups, where i is a positive integer and $N \geq i \geq 1$.

10. The memory device of claim 9, wherein each of the at least one process unit comprises M process elements configured to: perform convolution operations based on the ith first data segment of the N first data segments and the M second data segments of an ith data group of the N data groups.

11. The memory device of claim 10, wherein the control logic is further configured to control the page buffers to send the ith first data segment and the M second data segments to the M process elements.

12. The memory device of claim 11, wherein each of the at least one process unit comprises a control element configured to: assign the ith first data segment to each process element of the M process elements; and assign the M second data segments to the M process elements one-by-one based on a sequence of the M second data segments originally arranged in the second data.

13. The memory device of claim 11, wherein the array of memory cells is divided into more than one plane of memory cells; a number of the at least one process unit is equal to a number of the planes of memory cells; and each process unit corresponds to a corresponding one of the more than one planes of memory cells respectively.

14. The memory device of claim 11, wherein the array of memory cells is divided into more than one plane of memory cells; and a number of the at least one process unit is less than a number of the planes of memory cells.

15. The memory device of claim 1, wherein the memory device comprises a NAND flash memory.

16. A method for data calculation with a memory device comprising an array of memory cells and a peripheral circuit coupled to the memory cells, comprising: obtaining, by page buffers of the peripheral circuit, first data comprising at least one row from a data interface of the memory device; sensing, by the page buffers of the peripheral circuit, second data comprising at least two columns from the array of memory cells; receiving, by page buffers of the peripheral circuit, each row of the first data based on a first data pattern comprising at least two first data segments; programming the at least two columns of the second data into the array of memory cells based on a second data pattern comprising at least two data groups corresponding to the at least two first data segments of the first data pattern respectively; and performing a calculation, by at least one process unit of the peripheral circuit, based on the first data in the first data pattern and the second data in the second data pattern.

17. The method of claim 16, further comprising: programming the second data into the array of memory cells.

18. A system, comprising: a memory device comprising: an array of memory cells; and a peripheral circuit coupled to the memory cells and comprising: page buffers configured to store first data comprising at least one row transmitted from a data interface of the memory device and to sense second data comprising at least two columns from the array of memory cells; and at least one process unit coupled to the page buffers via a data-path bus of the peripheral circuit, and configured to perform calculation based on the first data and the second data; and a controller coupled with the memory device and configured to: transmit each row of the first data into the memory device based on a first data pattern comprising at least two first data segments with equal data length, wherein two adjacent first data segments of the first data pattern are separated by at least two first blank segments; program the at least two columns of the second data into the array of memory cells based on a second data pattern comprising at least two data groups corresponding to the at least two first data segments of the first data pattern respectively; and receive a result of the calculation from the memory device.

19. The system of claim 18, wherein the memory device is a NAND flash memory.

20. The memory system of claim 18, wherein the first data pattern comprises more than two first data segments with equal data length, an order of the more than two first data segments matches a sequence of the more than two first data segments originally arranged in the first data, and every

two adjacent first data segments of the first data pattern are separated by more than two first blank segments; the second data pattern comprises more than two data groups each having more than two second data segments with equal data length from the more than two columns of the second data respectively, every two adjacent data groups of the more than two data groups of the second data pattern are separated by one second blank segment, each second blank segment is corresponded to a first data segment respectively; and the first data segment, the second data segment, the first blank segment, and the second blank segment are configured to have an equal data length.
